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Digital Literacy Project

VITyarthi E-Learning Platform

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Introduction:

This project was done as part of the Digital Literacy course to help us understand how to use digital tools properly in our academic and daily life. As a Student Digital Ambassador, my role was to create a portfolio with the aim of promoting digital literacy and responsible online behaviour among fellow students.

The project includes five distinct tasks which include making an infographic, creating online profiles, exploring coding platforms, writing professional emails, and learning about cybercrime. Each task provided me with practical experience instead of just theory.

Overall, this project helped me become more confident in using digital tools and understand how important it is to behave responsibly online.

Task 1:

Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic:

For this task, I used a design tool, **Canva,** to make a one-page presentation/ infographic which explains what digital literacy is, recommends some useful digital tools for students, and outlines safe internet practices which students should follow. In this rapidly evolving world, digital literacy is not simply a specialized skill, but rather an essential set of knowledge that all people must possess to live a safe and convenient life in this age of technological boom.

The information is given in short points instead of long paragraphs to ensure maximum retention and clarity for readers. I used text boxes, icons and shapes of different colours and also added animation to the slide.

What I found most difficult but also interesting is how the layers work, sometimes I sent things way to back so that none of it was even visible or added images on top of text. I also found it quite intriguing how the tools display the spatial relationship and measurements of the selected component in relation to other components.

Task 2:

Build Your Student Digital Portfolio

For this task, my goal was to set up a foundational portfolio across the key platforms that employers, internship coordinators, and the academic community check. I created accounts on **Kaggle, LinkedIn** and on **GitHub.**

GitHub is a platform that allows developers to host repositories and create, store, manage, and share their code. It provides tools for version control, collaboration, and project management, helping teams work efficiently on projects of any size.

On **GitHub**, I created my profile README and will upload my projects regularly to show my programming skills. In the next four years, I plan to use GitHub to practice coding and build a strong project portfolio.

LinkedIn is used for professional networking, career development, job searching, and personal branding.
On LinkedIn, I made an account and filled in the Education section. I plan to use it to build a strong professional network, connect with others, and to stay updated on industry news, trends and opportunities.

Kaggle is a powerful online platform where the data science and machine learning community come together. On Kaggle, I created a new account, which I updated with my educational details. I plan to use it to participate in competitions to improve my data science and machine learning skills.

Overall, I plan to use these platforms to improve my skills, grow my network, and prepare for my future career.

Task 3:

Explore Coding & Collaboration Platforms

For this task, the goal was to explore the right online tools for studying, practising, and collaborating. This task builds familiarity with two categories: coding practice platforms and collaboration tools.

For collaboration tools, I used Google Forms to make a “Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz” containing four MCQ-type questions and one short answer-type question. I added both multiple-choice and short answer questions. I also linked it to Google Sheets to collect answers. This helped me see all responses in one place.

This was a short quiz, but it helped me understand all the ways in which this platform can be used. This has a large number of applications, especially in academic settings. It can be used for quizzes, tests, assignment submissions, registration for events, surveys, taking suggestions, complaints and even as a poll amongst collaborators.

Task 4:

Draft a Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

Social Media Do's and Don'ts checklist:

❖ **Do's:**

- Think before you post – Make sure your content reflects your values and won't harm your reputation.
- Protect your privacy – Adjust privacy settings and avoid sharing sensitive personal information.
- Be respectful – Communicate politely and consider others' feelings and perspectives.
- Verify information – Check facts before sharing news or claims to avoid spreading misinformation.
- Use social media productively – Follow educational pages, join academic groups, and build your network.

❖ **Don'ts:**

- Overshare personal details — Avoid posting your address, phone number, or financial information.
- Engage in online arguments — Avoid all sorts of arguments as heated debates can escalate quickly and damage your image.
- Post inappropriate content — Offensive or unprofessional posts can affect future opportunities.
- Fall for fake news or scams — Be cautious of suspicious links and offers.
- Neglect real-life responsibilities —Avoid excessive use that interferes with studies or relationships.

This task was focused on learning how to draft a professional email and learning the etiquette guide and Social Media Do's and Don'ts.

The second part of the task is outlined above in a bulleted checklist. These tips, while useful for every person, is especially useful for college or university students in India.

For the first part of the task, I wrote two emails — one to a professor requesting an extension on an assignment submission deadline and the other to an internship coordinator at a company, expressing interest in a summer internship opportunity. Being able to digitally communicate in an appropriate way is an essential skill to have in this day and age.

Say, hypothetically, there are three students in a class who have accidentally been marked as absent, in spite of being present.

The professor has a rule of being contacted only through mail regarding attendance and not in his cabin. One of the students, despite being aware of this rule, was not confident in his abilities to communicate effectively digitally so decided to disregard said rule and meet the professor in his cabin, only earning a tongue-lashing as the professor was not receptive to what he was saying. So, despite being present and honest regarding his complaints, he was not granted his attendance.

The second student mailed him, but was still not granted his attendance though. Why was that the case? Because the way he addressed him and wrote the mail was so unprofessional that he presented a wrongful image of himself in front of the professor that it was assumed that was a dishonest person. No appropriate greeting, writing in informal language and in an accusatory manner and no proper sign-off.

The third one though, mailed him and mailed him well. He wrote an appropriate subject line and appropriate salutations, addressing him as "Respected Sir", wrote in formal, professional language, granted thanks and apologized for inconvenience caused and signed off properly, with "Yours sincerely" and with his name, reg no. and class

details. And, because he followed the rules and also knew how to communicate properly digitally, he was granted his attendance.

Task 5:

Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention Guide (Prevention Checklist)

This task focused on creating a “Stay Safe Online” checklist with prevention tips that help minimalize a person’s chances to fall prey to online fraudulent tactics. These tips are extremely useful for students in India.

While researching cybercrime, I was taken aback by how easily people fall victim to scams through simple tricks like fake links or urgent payment requests. Many attacks don’t require advanced hacking skills—they rely on manipulating human behaviour. I also learned how quickly financial fraud can happen, especially through UPI apps, and how important it is to act fast by reporting incidents. This made me realize that being aware is the first line of defence.

As a result of this learning, one habit I will change is being more careful and thinking before I click or respond to anything online. I will always check the sender’s details, verify UPI requests properly, and never scan unknown QR codes. I will also make sure to use strong passwords and enable two-factor authentication on all my important accounts. These small changes will help me stay safe and avoid online scams.

Conclusion:

This Digital Literacy project has been a valuable learning experience that strengthened my understanding of essential digital skills required in today's world. Through practical tasks, I learned how to create informative content, build a professional online presence, explore useful platforms, and communicate effectively through emails. I also gained awareness about cybercrime and the importance of staying safe online. The project helped me improve both my technical and communication skills while encouraging responsible digital behaviour. Overall, it has increased my confidence in using digital tools efficiently and prepared me to use technology in a smarter, safer, and more professional manner.

References:

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